

THE MOVE

Long form: Given [specific context], it makes sense that [reaction] would show up. That does not mean [the problem] is okay; it means your response has a reason. What would help now? -> Short form: context -> reaction -> dignity -> distinction ?

START HERE

Given [specific context], it makes sense that [reaction] would show up.

SAY THIS

Quick one-liners	<i>"That makes sense in context."</i>
Social and personal	<i>"Given how sudden that was, it makes sense you feel thrown."</i>
Work and process	<i>"Given the unclear handoff, it makes sense the team felt exposed."</i>
Digital and text	<i>"Given the timing, I can see why that message landed badly."</i>
Reaction, not the pro...	<i>"That does not mean the situation was okay."</i>
High-pressure mome...	<i>"Given the stakes, it makes sense your body went straight to alert mode."</i>

AVOID

- There is an immediate safety risk and action is needed before reassurance.
- The person is asking for accountability, and normalising would sound like excusing the harm.
- You do not yet understand enough context to normalise responsibly.

REMEMBER

Normalise the reaction, not the problem.